investor, Jhunjhunwala suffered sizeable losses during the technology rally of 2000. He invested heavily in the shares of public sector firms and other old-economy companies. Simultaneously, he short-sold most of the junk technology stocks being rigged by Ketan.

The stocks Rakesh bought fell, despite the companies being fundamentally sound and even paying good dividends in many cases. And the price of the junk shares that he short-sold kept rising in value, forcing him to buy back those shares at a loss. In short, both his investing and trading calls were going wrong.

When the tech bubble finally burst, he recouped some of the trading losses by again shorting the same set of market-fancied stocks that had caused him grief in the past. But the bear market that followed shrank the value of his long-term portfolio considerably. More trouble followed, as his trades were also probed by the regulator for alleged bear hammering, post the Budget in February 2001.

But Rakesh’s patience and his penchant for quality stocks began yielding fruit as the market recovered. Value investing was back in fashion, and Rakesh was the embodiment of it. His stakes in companies like Titan Industries, CRISIL, Matrix Laboratories, Geometric Software and Hawkins Cookers had appreciated significantly since the time he had started buying them. A feature on him in the October edition of *Outlook* magazine pegged the value of his 1 per cent-plus stakes in twenty-one companies at Rs 114 crore.

Of course, the market had grown too big over the last few years for any one individual to dictate the trend. When Ketan’s stars were rising, the market was still shallow in terms of trading volumes and quality of stocks. FII activity was mostly concentrated in the top 20-25 stocks. Thanks to dematerialization of shares, the tech boom and the US listing of some Indian companies, more foreign investors were eager to invest in India where there was now a wider range of superior companies to choose from. Rakesh would go on to have a huge following in the market over the next few years. And while he would never evoke the mass frenzy for a stock that a Harshad or Ketan could at their prime, his investment style endured, despite a fair share of bad bets.

Soon he began to be referred to as ‘India’s Warren Buffet’ by the media, a comparison he always resented. Rakesh credited Buffet with having far